



# The Outreach We're Not Doing

We've built a great system for *making* open calls and exhibitions — and almost no system for **promoting** them.

There's a tool we already own that fills the gap.

For Scott & Elise

Not Real Art · Artsville · Arterial

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## THE PROBLEM

# Three Gaps We Keep Hitting

### No central repository

Press & outreach contacts live in inboxes and people's heads — not a shared, structured system.

### No active owner

Promotion is whoever-has-time — which means it mostly doesn't happen.

### No PR cadence

Releases go out sporadically — not before, on, and after each open call and show.

*"We notify the right sources every time we launch a call — because our own email can't be it. It's too weak or small."* — Thursday Open Call meeting

## THE APPROACH

# Own The Engine, Plug In The Tools

We don't need to *adopt a PR platform*. We need a promotion engine — and we already own most of one. Extend what we have; rent only commodity inputs.

### The engine we own (the spine)

- **Promotion repository** — extend the Artwork Archive Airtable (campaigns + open calls + submissions) with releases, playbook, contacts, partner registry, assets
- **Our own press-release generator** — reuse the AI content gen in the-intersect-curator / PolyWiz
- **n8n** — fires the playbook on every call

### Plug-in tools (swappable)

- **PressRanger** — a journalist-DB feed + pitch radar we already own
- **Wires** — EIN / eReleases / PressRanger, per release
- **Listing boards & partners** — where we register calls

Same principle as Idea 009 — own the layer; don't rent your spine. If a tool's data or pricing changes, swap the feed, not the engine.

ONE TOOL WE ALREADY OWN

# PressRanger — A Cheap, Already-Owned Feed

Scott and Juergen both bought **PressRanger** on an AppSumo lifetime deal — and forgot about it. Reminded, Scott's reaction: *"Happy to start leveraging it... given the low cost, it'd be interesting to turn it into a capability for artists or galleries."*

**500K+**

journalists

**160K+**

publishers / outlets

**200K+**

podcasts

**\$0**

our monthly cost

Juergen's account is **AppSumo Tier 3** — 10 brands, 4,000 contact exports/mo, pitch notifications, custom media rooms. Already enough to start.

THE KEY INSIGHT

# It's Really Two Products In One Box

## THE ASSET — WE OWN IT

### Media database + CRM + AI

Find journalists & podcasts, draft releases and pitches with AI, track relationships, catch inbound press requests. **This lane costs \$3K–\$40K/yr elsewhere.**

## A COMMODITY — PAY PER USE

### Pay-per-release wire

\$299–\$399 to syndicate a release to 400–500 outlets. Useful, optional — and **not the bargain** (see next slide).

Mine the **software**. Shop the **wire** like any other line item.

WHAT THE SOFTWARE DOES

# The Half That's Worth Our Time

## Media databases

Search journalists, outlets & podcasts by beat, location, activity.

## AI campaigns

Auto-builds a target list with fit scores; drafts releases & pitches.

## Built-in CRM

Track Pitched → Replied → Published per campaign.

## Pitch radar

Inbound press requests (HARO & more), scored for relevance.

## Media room

A custom-domain newsroom per brand for our releases.

## White-label

Brandable reports — the path to PR-as-a-service for our artists.

"IS IT ACTUALLY CHEAPER?"

# The Software Is The Bargain — Not The Wire

## SOFTWARE (WE PAY \$0)

| TOOL        | REAL COST / YR |
|-------------|----------------|
| PressRanger | \$0 — owned    |
| Prowly      | ~\$3,100       |
| Cision      | ~\$10K–15K     |
| Meltwater   | ~\$15K–40K+    |

## WIRE (PER RELEASE)

| SERVICE       | PRICE              |
|---------------|--------------------|
| EIN Presswire | ~\$149             |
| PressRanger   | \$299 / \$399      |
| eReleases     | \$399+ (nonprofit) |
| PR Newswire   | \$1,500–3,000      |

PressRanger's wire is **not discounted by our subscription** — anyone with a free account pays the same. It's mid-market, not cheap. Our savings are entirely in the **software** we already own.



## DISTRIBUTION STRATEGY

# Shop The Wire By The Story

### Routine open call

Free listing boards + targeted pitches + paid social. **No paid wire**, or EIN Presswire (~\$149) for cheap SEO pickup.

### Notable story

**PressRanger Gold (\$399)** when AI-chatbot indexing (AIWire) + podcast reach earns it.

### Marquee moment

**eReleases / CauseWire** — real PR Newswire reach at nonprofit rates, for a flagship grant or partnership.

The database, CRM and pitching are the workhorse. The paid wire is the exception.



EYES OPEN

# What PressRanger Isn't

## Noisy data

Beats are matched by keyword on bios — arts lists carry false positives. One test: a 100-contact list exported with only ~8 direct emails.

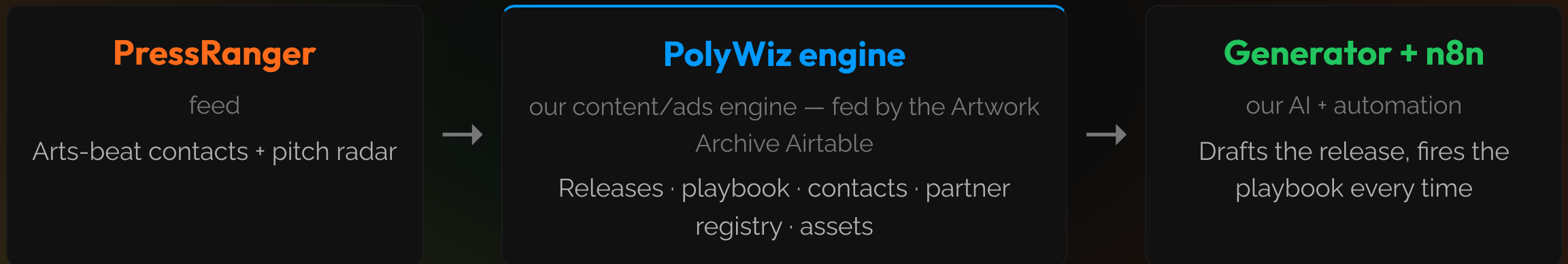
## Send with care

Blasting cold email from the tool can hurt deliverability. Pitch small + personal from it; blast the artist list from our own ESP.

So: PressRanger for **discovery**, a curated Airtable as our **source-of-truth**, and disciplined sending — never "trust the raw list and hit send."

THE SYSTEM IN PRACTICE

# Our Stack Is The Spine — PressRanger Feeds It



The "institutionalize the outreach" ask — but the spine is **ours**, not rented. Swap any feed without touching the engine.

WHERE TO REGISTER — US-WIDE

# Most Of This Reach Is Free, And Unused

## FREE LISTING BOARDS

EntryThingy  
ArtCallEntry  
Artwork Archive  
ArtConnect  
Fractured Atlas  
+ CaFÉ for juried intake

## ORGS & PARTNERS

NYFA Opportunities  
Americans for the Arts  
Artist Communities Alliance  
Creative Capital list  
State / regional councils  
NEA — fund our program

## AMPLIFIERS TO PITCH

Hyperallergic (tips@)  
This Is Colossal  
Create! Magazine  
Art Opportunities Monthly  
Booooooom  
Arts to Hearts

Full directory with URLs, fees and contacts in [research/submission-platforms.md](#). We're not posting to most of these today.

## THE PLAYBOOK

# Same Steps, Every Call, Every Show

| MOMENT          | PRESS RELEASE | FREE LISTINGS | ARTIST EMAIL | PAID SOCIAL |
|-----------------|---------------|---------------|--------------|-------------|
| Open call opens | ✓             | ✓             | ✓            | ✓           |
| Show announced  | ✓             | —             | ✓            | optional    |
| Exhibition live | ✓             | —             | ✓            | optional    |

The grant campaigns over-performed because we ran **Facebook ads to the landing pages** — not organic luck. Open calls deserve the same multi-channel treatment, pointed at one aligned registration URL with UTMs so we can measure it.

THE LEVER THAT MOVES NUMBERS

# Paid Social, Automated Through PolyWiz

PR + listings + email harvest *existing* intent. Paid social **manufactures new intent** — and we already scoped the engine in Idea 007. Add one thin **"Open Calls" category** to it.

## What it does

A new open-call record auto-generates 8–15 ad variants → **Meta + Pinterest** via Zernio, optimized for **submissions**, plus organic reminders trickled across the run (opened → 1 week left → 48h).

## Why Pinterest

Visual-discovery, art-aligned audience, native lead ads, **CPC 30–50% under Meta**. Open calls are the use case that justifies turning it on.

## Conservative budget

**~\$150–\$300 per call** (short flights, not always-on). First test: one brand, one call, ~\$250 — to measure cost-per-submission for the *first time*.

Compounds: submissions now + newsletter signups + a retargeting pool that makes the next call cheaper. Same engine repoints at donors in the fall.

## PHASING

# Start Small, Earn The Next Phase

### PHASE 1 — NOW

#### Open-call promotion

Stand up Airtable, codify the playbook, run it live on [Art of Resistance](#). Owner: Elise.

### PHASE 2 — FALL

#### Fundraising

Same engine, pointed at donors & impact press once the books / DAF groundwork lands.

### PHASE 3 — OPTIONAL

#### PR-as-a-service

White-label the playbook for the artists & galleries in our network — Scott's instinct.

## THE ASK

# What We Need To Decide

- 1 **Reactivate access.** Scott is sharing the password with Elise & Juergen. Juergen's Tier 3 account is enough to start now.
- 2 **Elise evaluates it** against a real call — "can it find & help us reach arts journalists, podcasts and partners?" — not as an abstract tool review.
- 3 **Review as a team** on a Thursday — agree the playbook, the Airtable schema, and the first live test.





# Short Version

We already own most of a promotion engine. [Extend the Artwork Archive](#) [Airtable](#) into a press-release + playbook system, build a small [generator](#), plug [PressRanger in as one cheap feed](#), and register every call across the free US-wide boards. Give Elise the wheel for one real open call — and we finally promote our calls instead of just running them.

Let's pick a call and try it. — Juergen Berkessel, Polymash

# Sources & References

## Evidence behind the claims in this deck

PressRanger features & databases (500K journalists / 160K publishers / 200K podcasts), CRM, AI, pitch radar, white-label — [pressranger.com/pages/pr-software](https://pressranger.com/pages/pr-software) + journalist / publisher / podcast / pitch-request pages. First-party, retrieved 2026-06-12.

Distribution \$299 Premium / \$399 Gold, not subscription-gated, AIWire — PressRanger wholesale distribution & pricing.

EIN Presswire ~\$149/release; budget wires — [einpresswire.com/pricing](https://einpresswire.com/pricing). eReleases \$399+ & nonprofit CauseWire — [ereleases.com/causewire](https://ereleases.com/causewire). PR Newswire real \$1,500–3,000 — Prezly PR Newswire pricing.

Cision ~\$10–15K/yr · Meltwater ~\$15–40K/yr · Prowly ~\$3,100/yr — Prowly; Prezly (estimates; custom-quote vendors).

Data-quality caveat (~8 emails on a 100-contact export; keyword categorization) — AppSumo reviews; Research.com.

US-wide listing boards, partners & amplifiers (EntryThingy, ArtCallEntry, Artwork Archive, ArtConnect, Fractured Atlas, NYFA, Americans for the Arts, Artist Communities Alliance, Creative Capital, Hyperallergic, This Is Colossal, Booooooom) — grounded Perplexity + WebSearch, 2026-06; URLs in the research file.

Full URLs, quotes, retrieval dates, account-confirmed Tier 3 capacity, and the meeting transcript: **research/sources.md** in the idea folder. Pricing was current June 2026 — verify before quoting.